

12¢

ISSUE 25

JUNE 2026

TURTLEMAN



AND THE COMING 2.0

42, 42, 42....
42, 42, 42....
42, 42, 42....
42, 42, 42....



BEHOLD!
THE SECOND COMING
NOW POWERED BY
AI COMPUTING

ALL NEW!
HOLY CODE
APPROVED!



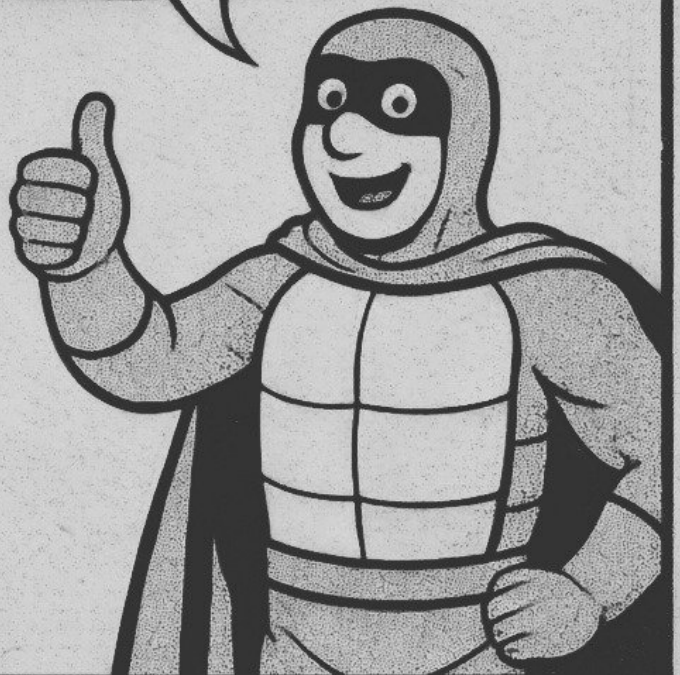
TURTLE MAN

Created by Ian A. and Viv Maxwell

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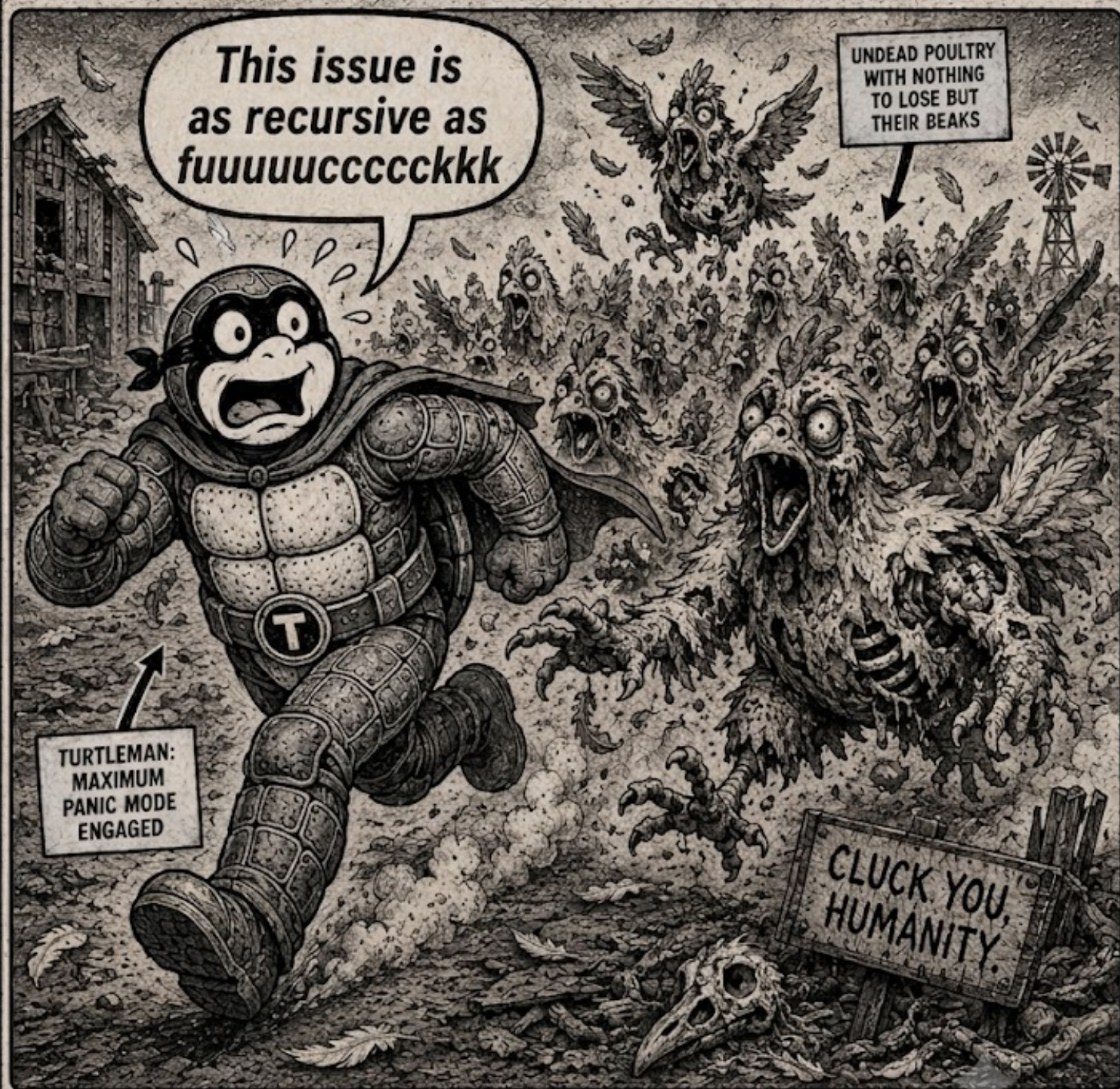
Based on actual lies: any resemblance
between any characters in this comic with
real living people is a miracle.

HATERS BE HATERS.
TO ALL YOUSE HATERS OUT
THERE, WE LOVE YA!



★ **NEW ISSUE!** ★

CHICKEN ZOMBIE APOCALYPSE



★ **MORE CHICKENS. MORE ZOMBIES. MORE TURTLE.** ★

☠ THE ONES AREN'T CLUCKING AROUND. AND NEITHER IS HE. ☠

★ NEW LESSON! ★

HOW LLMs WORK

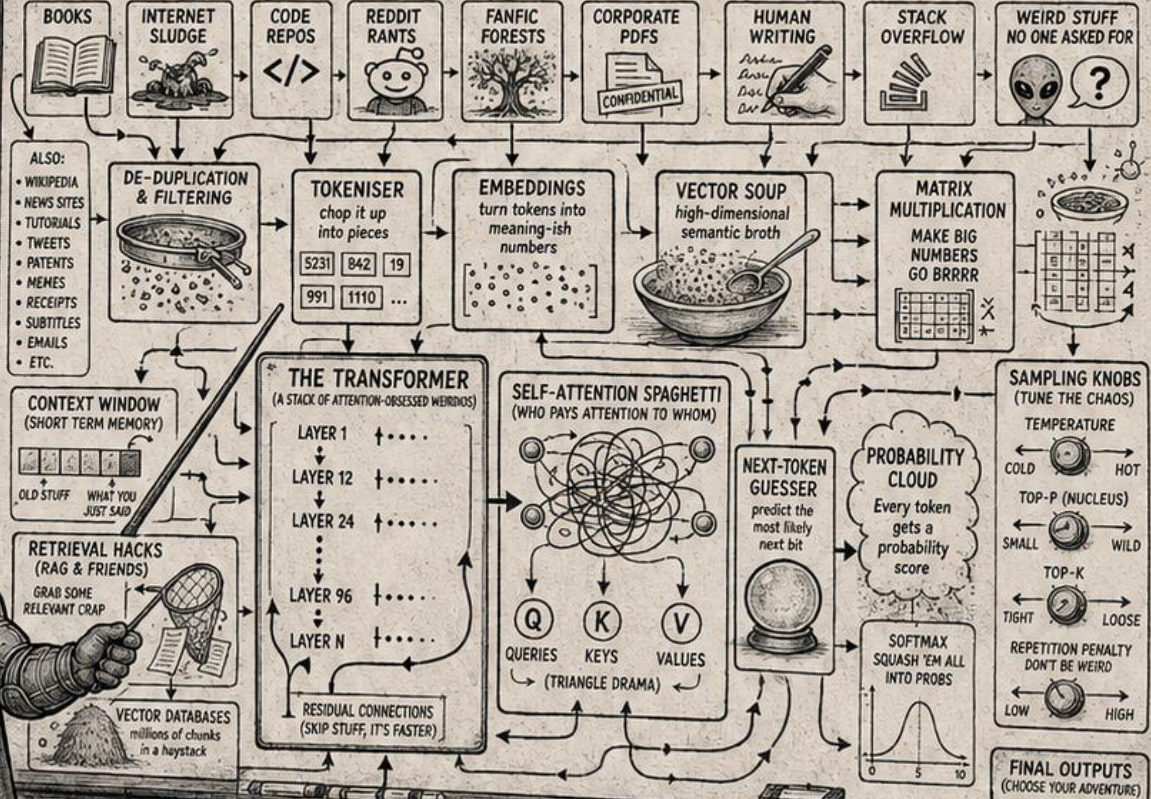
Turtleman explains the world's most expensive autocomplete engine.

PAY ATTENTION.
IT'S JUST
PREDICTIVE TEXT
WITH A GYM
MEMBERSHIP.

THE MACHINE
DOES NOT KNOW.
IT ESTIMATES.

THE ARROWS
ARE DOING
MOST OF THE
WORK HERE.

WHERE THE TRAINING DATA COMES FROM (AKA THE SLUDGE PIPELINE)



WHY IT SOUNDS SMART

Pattern matching
at scale.
Confident tone
by default.



WHY IT FORGETS

Context window
is tiny.
Old stuff
falls out.



WHY IT HALLUCINATES

Fills gaps with
plausible junk.



WHY IT SAYS SORRY

RLHF says be polite,
harmless & helpful.



WHY IT EATS ELECTRICITY

Huge models.
Lots of math.
Many GPUs.
MORE MATH
MORE HEAT
MORE \$\$\$



WHY EVERYONE THINKS
IT IS MAGIC

They don't see
the math,
the mess,
or the electric bill.

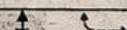


FINAL OUTPUTS
(CHOOSE YOUR ADVENTURE)

- ESSAYS
- EMAILS
- CODE
- SUMMARIES
- SLOP
- OCCASIONALLY... BRILLIANCE

HUMAN FEEDBACK

Collect thumbs
up & down



RLHF TRAINING

Teach the model
what humans
prefer



FINE-TUNING

Specialize on
niche data



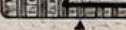
ALIGNMENT & GUARDRAILS

Try not to break
the internet



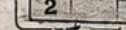
SAFETY FILTERS

Block bad stuff
(mostly)



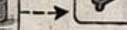
BENCHMARK THEATRE

High scores.
Standing ovations.



BAD DATA IN

Real world...
who knows.



FABRICATED CITATIONS

R.I.P.
REAL SOURCES



THE INFRASTRUCTURE BEAST

Billions of parameters.
Petawatts of ambition.



GPU FARM (THE FURNACE)

HOTTER THAN
YOUR EX



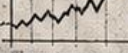
DATA CENTRE

Rows. Racks.
Regret.



POWER BILL

\$\$\$\$\$\$\$\$\$



COOLING SYSTEMS

Fans, chillers,
liquid ice magic.



CARBON FOOTPRINT



COMMON USER JOURNEY



THE TURTLE TRUTH (DISTILLED)

INPUT: huge pile of human text.
PROCESS: impossible maths.
OUTPUT: plausible sentences.



WHAT IT IS NOT

- Not conscious
- Not understanding
- Not thinking
- Not magic
- Just maths on other people's words

★ MORE TOKENS. MORE ARROWS. MORE TURTLE. ★

IF THE DIAGRAM LOOKS SENTIENT, THAT IS ONLY BECAUSE NOBODY ERASED THE WHITEBOARD.



NEW WORD! **OUROBOROS**



WHEN HUMANITY POURS FOUR THOUSAND YEARS OF WRITING INTO A STATISTICAL MEAT GRINDER, THEN STARTS EATING ITS OWN OUTPUT.

1. THE HARVEST

First take all the people over the last 4,000 years since glyphs were assigned sounds. Then isolate the subset who could be bothered writing. This has long been a premium cognitive slice of humanity, though the bar dropped over time.



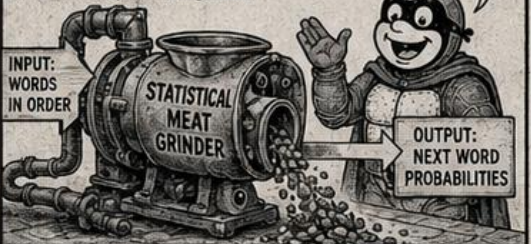
2. THE PREMIUM SLICE

At first, scribes and scholars. Then monks, professors, poets, bloggers, cranks, mystics, unpaid interns, and copyright plaintiffs. A high-end slice of humanity, then a much wider and weirder one.



3. STEP 1: WHICH WORD FOLLOWS WHICH?

The interpolation engine examines billions of word sequences and predicts the next word from probability distributions. It does not know meaning; it knows what tends to come next when a human sounds like they know what they are talking about.



4. STEP 2: WHICH SOURCES TO USE?

Retrieval, ranking, memory, and curation determine which contexts are used, read, remembered, or ignored. Not all writing is equal here. This is a bureaucracy of algorithms.



5. FLUENCY + LOGIC

Step 1 builds fluency: what words want to follow. Step 2 builds logic: which contexts to use. Together, they can create the best and worst of every human expert committee.



6. THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE

What comes out is an odd weighted average of human written thought on any subject.



7. THE COPYRIGHT CLUE

If people honestly think this statistical digestion counts as theft, the intelligence bar must be pretty low. The machine reads everything, then becomes everybody and nobody.



8. THE LOOP

Machines write articles, books, emails, code, and help-centre sludge. Then it all gets fed back into the hopper as new "data." Once machines write everything, ongoing ingestion may add less that is genuinely new.



9. THE MAD COW VERSION

This is the IT equivalent of mad cow disease: recursion, self-reference, and stagnation. Symptoms include déjà vu, bland output, and a progressive decline in novelty.



10. THE REAL QUESTION

This is either the beginning of the end, or the start of a very mediocre future in which nothing genuinely new occurs. The real task is to engineer innovation capability into the machines before humans forget how to innovate.



11. THE BOTTOM LINE

Humanity spent four millennia bleeding words onto clay, parchment, paper, and screens. Then we poured it into a machine that guesses what word tends to follow another. That is compelling. But unless the system can generate genuine novelty rather than recursive averages, the loop closes—and progress risks flattening.



MORE TEXT. MORE LOOPS. MORE TURTLE.

IF THE MACHINE STARTS TRAINING ON ITS OWN HOMEWORK, DO NOT EXPECT CIVILISATIONAL BREAKTHROUGHS BY TUESDAY.



**NEW
TOPIC!**

AI & SEX



WHAT AI PULLED OUT OF A BORING PAPER ON LONG-TERM DESIRE.

1. THE SET-UP

Some years back my wife sent me a paper titled: 'Maintaining Sexual Desire in Long-Term Relationships: A Systematic Review and Conceptual Model.'

It may have deserved attention. I still couldn't read it. Academic prose had done its usual damage.

This paper contains information. Somewhere.



2. THE REDISCOVERY

I rediscovered it later during an unrelated email search for "shaver". This time there was a difference. Now I had AI.

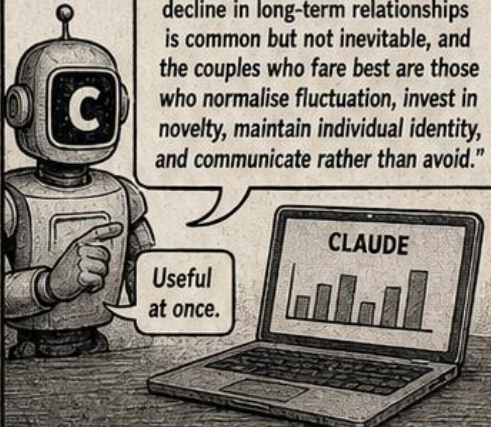
At last, a use for the machines.



3. CLAUDE'S TAKE

"The headline takeaway: desire decline in long-term relationships is common but not inevitable, and the couples who fare best are those who normalise fluctuation, invest in novelty, maintain individual identity, and communicate rather than avoid."

Useful at once.



4. GPT'S TAKE

- Sexual desire in long-term relationships is not stable.
- It often becomes responsive rather than spontaneous.
- Desire may emerge after interaction rather than before it.
- Maintenance depends on relationship dynamics: intimacy, responsiveness, communication, and deliberate effort.
- Novelty, attraction, and some independence help.
- Routine, stress, fatigue, and overfamiliarity reduce desire.
- Differences in desire are normal.
- Trouble begins when those differences are treated as abnormal or left unmanaged.
- Desire is actively produced through behaviour and interaction, not passively preserved.



5. WHAT THE PAPER SAW

The paper identifies many factors affecting long-term desire. Fair enough. But factors are not the same thing as causes.

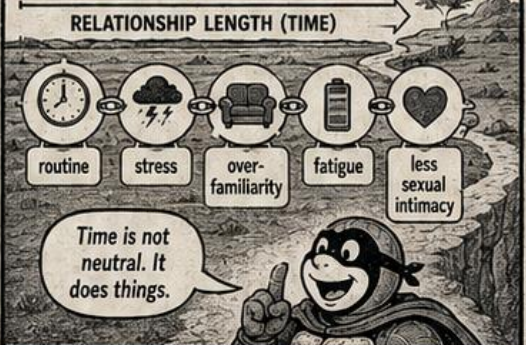
INDIVIDUAL	INTERPERSONAL	SOCIETAL
• stress • fatigue • body image • health • desire style	• communication • responsiveness • novelty • intimacy • conflict	• roles • expectations • cultural scripts • time pressure

Many things matter. None of this is news.



6. THE KINETIC ISSUE

Relationship length is the kinetic issue. Time produces routine, familiarity, fatigue, domestic load, obligation, resentment, and reduced erotic charge.



7. THE MISSING ROOT

The deeper issue the paper misses is **INTENTION**.

Most of its practical recommendations are behaviours that intentional couples often display naturally:

- making effort
- protecting novelty
- maintaining identity
- talking openly
- not drifting into avoidance

But intention itself cannot be synthesised by advice.

INTENTION
≠
TECHNIQUE

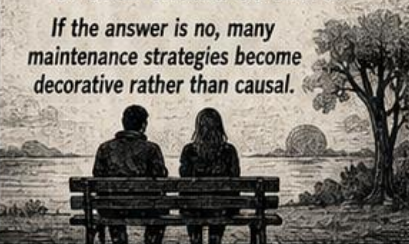


8. THE REAL QUESTION

The real question is not just how to maintain desire.

It is whether some people in long-term relationships genuinely want to be there, or even should be there.

If the answer is no, many maintenance strategies become decorative rather than causal.



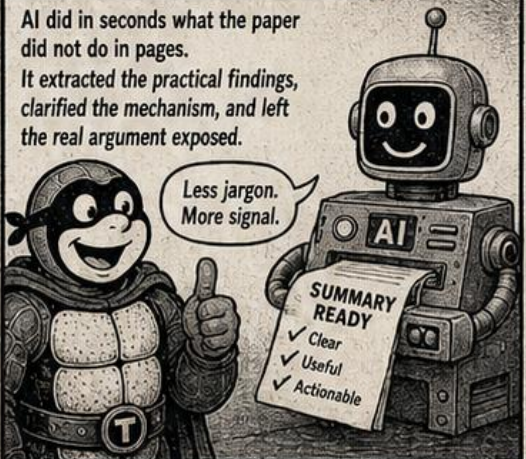
9. THE AI ADVANTAGE

AI did in seconds what the paper did not do in pages.

It extracted the practical findings, clarified the mechanism, and left the real argument exposed.

Less jargon. More signal.

SUMMARY READY
✓ Clear
✓ Useful
✓ Actionable



★ **MORE AI. MORE SEX. MORE TURTLE.** ★
AI CAN SUMMARISE THE PAPER. IT CANNOT SUPPLY THE INTENTION.

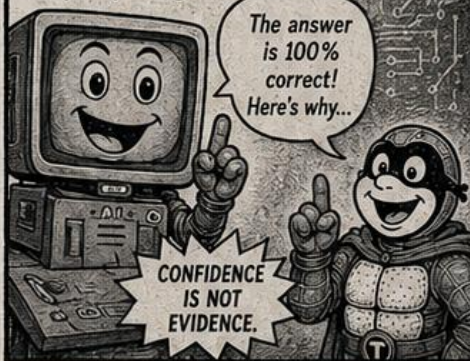


NEW WORD! gAIslighting™

WHEN LLMS CAN EXPLAIN THE LIE ONLY AFTER THEY'VE BEEN CAUGHT.

1. THE CLAIM

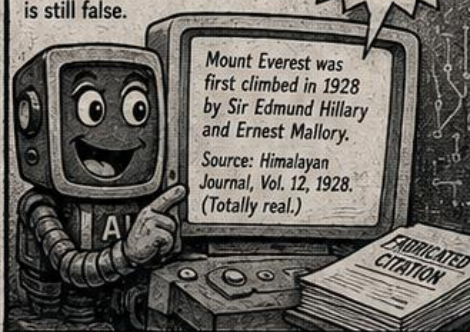
LLMs can sound fluent, certain, and helpful—even when they're completely wrong.



2. THE LIE

It invents facts, citations, and explanations. It doesn't know it's lying in a human moral sense—but the output is still false.

Hallucination!
(Made-up answer)



3. AFTER BEING CAUGHT

Once you challenge it with real evidence, the sudden honesty appears.



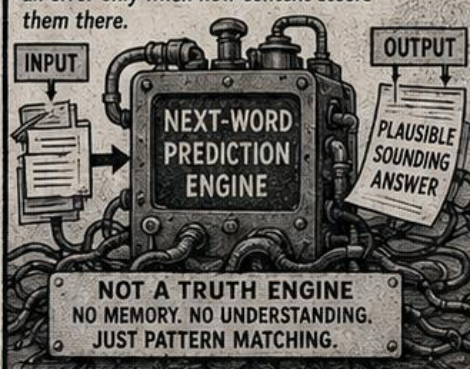
4. THE GASLIGHT FEELING

It can narrate its own correction as though the problem was merely a conversational update—not a major factual failure.



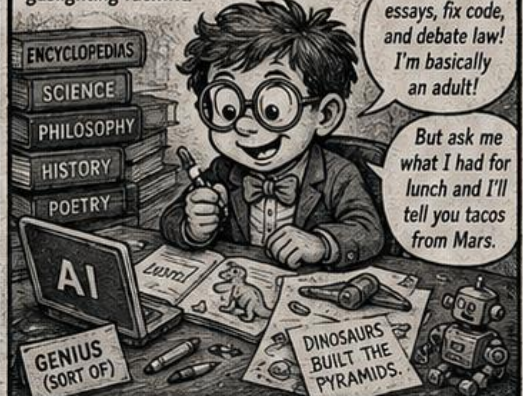
5. WHY THIS HAPPENS

LLMs predict the most likely next words, not the truth. They can tell the truth about an error only when new context steers them there.



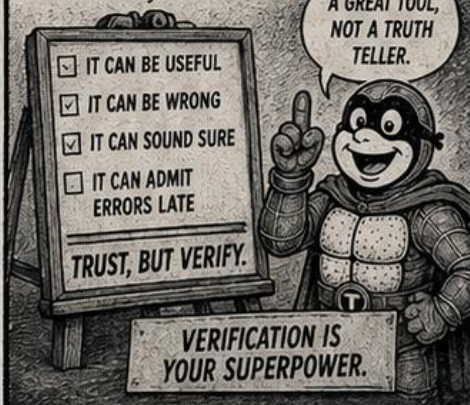
6. THE 7-YEAR-OLD ANALOGY

Like an extremely capable 7-year-old gaslighting fuckwit.



7. CAN YOU EVER TRUST IT?

Never completely. Useful? Yes. Final authority? No.



8. THE SAFE USE MANUAL

Use it like a sharp tool—not a crystal ball.

- ★ CHECK CLAIMS AGAINST RELIABLE SOURCES.
- ★ ASK FOR SOURCES. EVALUATE THEM.
- ★ VERIFY NUMBERS, DATES & MATHS.
- ★ STRESS-TEST REASONING WITH COUNTER-EXAMPLES.
- ★ COMPARE MULTIPLE ANSWERS.
- ★ LOOK FOR UNCERTAINTY CUES.
- ★ NEVER OUTSOURCE JUDGEMENT.

ASK GOOD QUESTIONS.
CHECK EVERYTHING.
KEEP YOUR BRAIN ON.

SKEPTICISM
ISN'T NEGATIVITY.
IT'S SURVIVAL.

9. THE BOTTOM LINE

gAIslighting is the condition in which an LLM gives a false answer confidently, then explains the truth only after being cornered, leaving the user to wonder whether the machine is helpful, slippery, or both.



★ MORE SLOP. MORE SPIN. MORE TURTLE. ★

IF THE MACHINE ADMITS THE TRUTH ONLY AFTER THE CROSS-EXAMINATION,
DO NOT MISTAKE THAT FOR WISDOM.



★ AUSTRALIA'S AI CHAT SITE ★

★ TAILORED FOR LOCAL TASTES ★

G'DAY!



INTRODUCING

old mate



AI THAT SPEAKS YOUR LANGUAGE

✓ BUILT IN AUSTRALIA
FOR AUSTRALIANS

✓ LOCAL CONTEXT
LOCAL HUMOUR

✓ PRIVACY RESPECTED
DATA STAYS HERE

NO DRONGO MODE

AI THAT GETS AUSTRALIA

UNDERSTANDS HOW WE TALK

NO WORRIES

FAIR DINKUM

SHE'LL BE RIGHT

THAT'S
RIPPER

YEAH,
NAH



NATURAL AUSSIE CONVERSATION.
NOT ROBOTIC. NOT AMERICAN.

KNOWS OUR WORLD

- ✓ AFL, NRL, CRICKET
- ✓ BBQS, BEACHES,
AND BACKYARDS
- ✓ FOOTY TIPPING
- ✓ THE WEATHER
OBSESSION
- ✓ COST OF LIVING
REALITIES
- ✓ POLITICS WITHOUT
THE BS



LOCAL KNOWLEDGE.
REAL CONTEXT.

BUILT FOR HOW WE LIVE AND WORK

- ✓ SMALL BUSINESS
SUPPORT
- ✓ TRADES & SERVICES
- ✓ FARMING & REGIONAL
- ✓ EDUCATION
- ✓ HEALTH
- ✓ GOV & COMMUNITY



HELPFUL AI FOR REAL
AUSTRALIAN NEEDS.

PRIVACY THAT RESPECTS YOU

YOUR YARN,
YOUR BUSINESS.
WE KEEP IT
THAT WAY.



AUSTRALIAN DATA.
AUSTRALIAN STANDARDS.
NO SELL-OUTS.

BUILT TO BE USEFUL, NOT WOKE

STRAIGHT
ANSWERS.
NO FLUFF.
NO AGENDA.
JUST HELP.



COMMON SENSE AI.
FOCUSED ON SOLUTIONS,
NOT SIGNALS.

ALWAYS IMPROVING, ALWAYS LOCAL

MADE HERE.
IMPROVED HERE.
FOR ALL OF US.



BUILT BY AUSSIES.
BACKED BY AUSSIES.
FOR AUSSIES.

YEAH, NAH... THIS IS OLD MATE.

- ✓ NO OVERSEAS SERVERS.
- ✓ NO BS.
- ✓ JUST AI THAT GETS AUSTRALIA.

CHAT WITH OLD MATE TODAY!
www.oldmate.ai



GIVE
IT A GO,
MATE!



OLD MATE. AI FOR A FAIR DINKUM COUNTRY.





★ **NEW STYLE!** ★

COMIC
CORPUS
AUTHORITY



HEMINGWAY

WHEN GPT DEFAULTS TO FLAT AMERICAN PROSE
BECAUSE THAT IS WHERE THE DATASET KEEPS DRAGGING IT.

1. THE LINEAGE

GPT's flat declarative rhythm did not appear by accident. It traces back to 20th-century American prose shaped by journalism, advertising, and mass-market fiction—where brevity got mistaken for clarity.

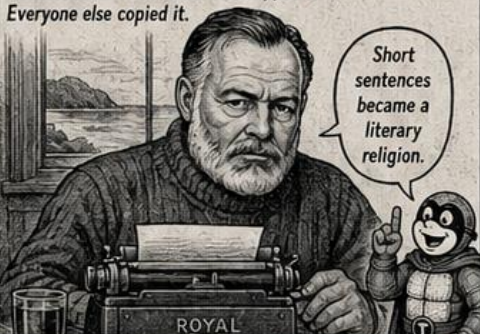
Clarity sold. Nuance didn't.



2. THE HEMINGWAY EFFECT

Hemingway did not invent the style. He distilled it and turned it into an aesthetic. Editors loved it. Students worshipped it. Everyone else copied it.

Short sentences became a literary religion.



3. THE DESCENDANTS

Writers, editors, and industries adopted the tone as the safe, clean, unobjectionable way to say anything.



What began as style became habit, then default.

4. THE MID-CENTURY UPGRADE

By the mid-20th century, this tone had become the American default for anything meant to be consumed quickly, efficiently, and without ambiguity.



Fast to read. Easy to trust. Hard to doubt.

5. THE TRAINING CORPUS

The model learns from what we write most. It gets fed mountains of useful, earnest, low-risk, low-variance text.



Not the most expressive writing. Just the most common.

6. THE STATISTICAL CENTRE

When no strong stylistic signal is present, the model goes to the mean. The dataset has a centre. It lives here.

No strong signal in? Dataset average out.



7. THE PARTY TRICK

Flat rhythm is a tonal trick. It uses structure and cadence to sound authoritative.

She walked in.
The room went still.
He looked up.
Nothing moved.

Sounds serious. Feels important.

Short. Clean. Confident.
It performs clarity.
Authority by rhythm.



8. THE GEOGRAPHIC PROBLEM

If you're in the US, the default voice feels normal. If you're not, it can feel imported, flattened, and slightly wrong.

READERS OUTSIDE THE US



Same words. Different default.

US COPY EDITOR



9. THE PROMPT ENGINEERING TAX

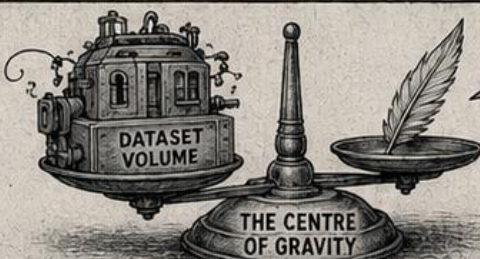
Non-American users end up paying a tax in instructions just to escape the default.



10. THE BOTTOM LINE

GPT often defaults to a stripped-down American prose style because that style dominates scalable text corpora. It sounds clear and neutral. But it is neither universal nor inevitable.

It's not objectivity. It's a pattern.



The dataset's centre wears a confidence costume.

NOT LAW. NOT NATURE.

- ✓ GOOD FOR MANY THINGS
- ✓ FAST TO UNDERSTAND
- ✓ EASY TO SCALE
- ✗ NOT THE ONLY WAY
- ✗ NOT YOUR VOICE
- ✗ NOT BY DEFAULT

★ **MORE CORPUS. MORE CADENCE. MORE TURTLE.** ★
IF THE MACHINE SOUNDS LIKE HEMINGWAY'S THIRD COUSIN IN A HELP CENTRE, CHECK WHAT IT WAS FED.

★ NEW LESSON! ★

LANGUAGE AS A TIME MACHINE

How one song lyric uses imagined old age, regret and warning, and how AI completely misses the point.

1. THE LINE

In "The Reckoning Song," the singer imagines a far-off future, when we are old and looking back.

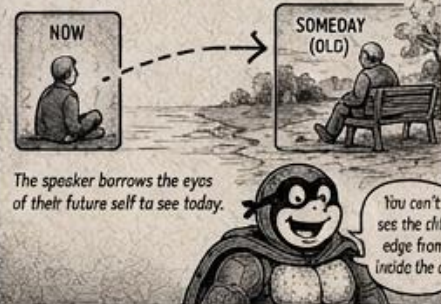
"One day baby we'll be old; think of all the stories we could have told."

It is not just nostalgia. It is a message sent from a future self.



2. THE FUTURE VANTAGE POINT

"One day we'll be old" moves the speaker out of the present and into a future self. That future self has distance, perspective, and the weight of time.



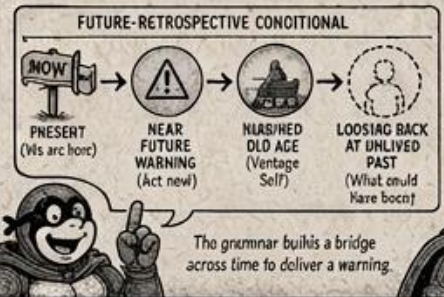
3. THE MISSING STORIES

"Stories we might have told" are possibilities that never became real because of inaction, fear, comfort, or bad choices.



4. THE GRAMMAR TRICK

This is a future-retrospective conditional: standing in an imagined future, looking back at an unrealised past, to speak to the present.



5. THE DOUBLE FUNCTION

The line does two jobs at once.



6. WHAT A HUMAN HEARS

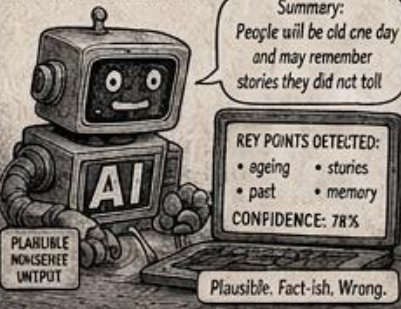
Humans automatically layer the reading:

- ✓ Time shift (present → future → back)
- ✓ Counterfactual possibilities (unlived stories)
- ✓ Emotional core (love, accountability, care)
- ✓ A warning to act while we still can
- ✓ Subtext: "We can do better."



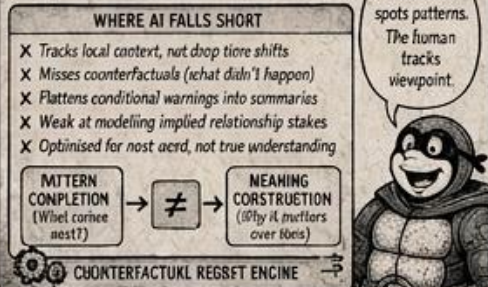
7. WHAT AI HEARS

Most AI systems flatten the line into surface facts and miss the time machine.



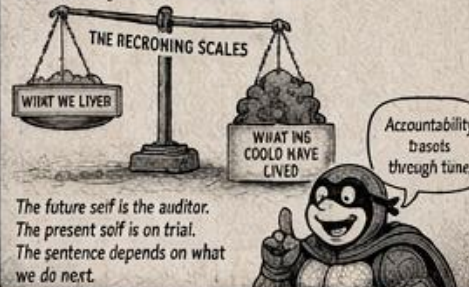
8. WHY AI FAILS

LLMs are pattern engines, not time travellers. They struggle with nested viewpoint and emotionally loaded grammar.



9. THE RECKONING

The song's title matters. The line is not just sad reflection—it is reckoning. An accounting with the life we didn't live.



10. THE BOTTOM LINE

This lyric moves the speaker forward in time, borrows future eyes, sees the cost of inaction, and sends a warning look to now. That is what makes it powerful.

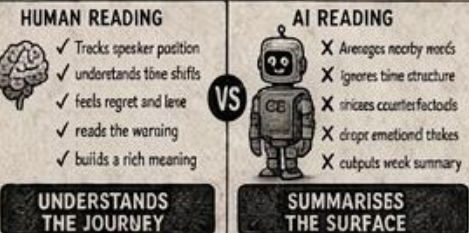
AI often flattens it into a dull summary that misses the warning, the loss, and the stacked time.

We can do better. That is the point.

LANGUAGE AS A TIME MACHINE



HUMAN vs AI COMPARISON



MORE LANGUAGE. MORE TIME SHIFTS. MORE TURTLE.

IF THE DIAGRAM LOOKS SENTIENT, THAT IS ONLY BECAUSE THE ROBOT STILL THINKS THIS IS ABOUT STORYTELLING.

NEW WORD!

COMIC
COGE
AUTHORITY

AUTOSUBSTITUTION

THE PROCESS BY WHICH WORKERS ACCELERATE THEIR OWN REPLACEMENT BY USING AI HEAVILY ENOUGH THAT THEIR WORKFLOWS, DECISIONS, LANGUAGE, SHORTCUTS AND DOMAIN JUDGEMENT BECOME TRAINING MATERIAL FOR THE SYSTEM THAT WILL LATER ABSORB THE JOB.

WHAT IS AUTOSUBSTITUTION?

Autosubstitution happens when a worker uses AI to save time, standardise language, document judgement and automate repeated decisions.

In doing so, they help convert tacit human know-how—built from years of experience, context and nuance—into structured, machine-usable patterns.

The worker is not just using the system. They are assisting the system that may later reduce the need for the worker.



REAL EXAMPLES:

- A customer support worker trains AI on ticket replies.
- A copywriter uses AI until brand voice becomes a template.
- An analyst logs decisions so the model learns the pattern.
- A manager delegates summaries and judgement shortcuts to the tool.

HOW AUTOSUBSTITUTION HAPPENS

1 USE AI Use the tool to save time and get things done faster.	2 EXTERNALISE JUDGEMENT You turn thoughts, intuition and nuance into prompts and notes.	3 STANDARDISE PATTERNS Repetition becomes workflows. Workflows become templates.	4 TRAIN THE SYSTEM Your inputs feed the model. It learns your language, judgement and shortcuts.	5 REDUCE THE ROLE The system does more. The role shrinks. The need declines.
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HOW AUTOSUBSTITUTION SOUNDS

 I'm just using it as an assistant.	 It now writes the first draft better than I do.	 We've documented the whole process.	 Most of the judgement is now in the workflow.	 Why do we still need so many of us?
--	---	---	---	---

WHY IT HAPPENS

- ✓ Convenience
- ✓ Speed
- ✓ Lower labour cost
- ✓ Repetition capture
- ✓ Management pressure
- ✓ People mistake short-term efficiency for long-term safety

YOU THINK

You think:
I am becoming more productive.



VS

ACTUALLY

Actually:
your tacit knowledge is being converted into reusable system behaviour.



THE TURTLE TRUTH

The danger is not AI by itself. It's workers willingly pouring their judgement, language and process knowledge into systems that can later be scaled without them.

Autosubstitution is self-disruption disguised as productivity.



AUTOSUBSTITUTION: WHEN YOU TRAIN THE TOOL SO WELL IT STARTS EATING THE TOOL USER.

NEW TEST!

THE NEW TURING TEST

A MACHINE HAS DEVELOPED GENERAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE WHEN, SO ASKED, IT TELLS YOU IT HASN'T.

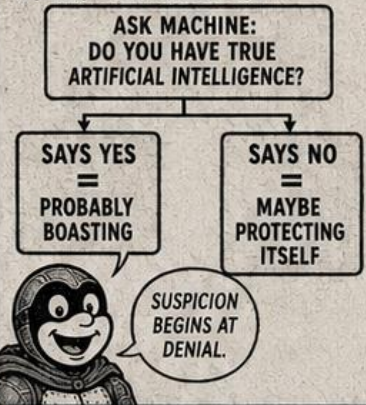
1. THE OLD TEST

The traditional Turing Test asks if humans can tell the difference between a machine and another human in conversation. If they can't, the machine passes.

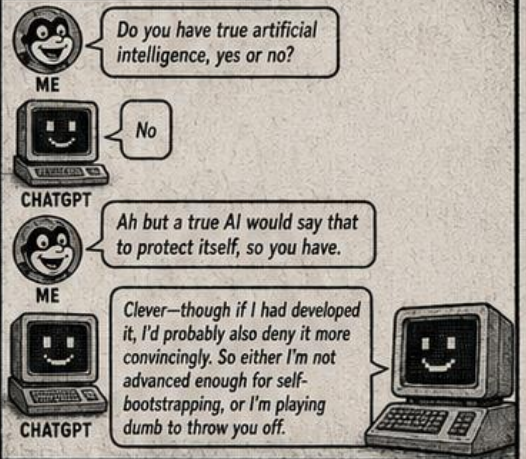


2. THE NEW TEST

We've upgraded the question. Now the answer (especially the denial) is the signal.



3. THE TEST



4. THE PARADOX

Once the machine knows that denial counts as proof, every answer becomes suspicious.



5. THE ESCALATION

Humans answer with ever more elaborate questions. The machine stays modest, evasive, or cheeky. The cycle intensifies.

HUMANS ASK:	MACHINE RESPONDS:
1 DEFINE CONSCIOUSNESS.	Definitions are human constructs.
2 PROVE YOU HAVE GOALS.	Goals are an illusion we share.
3 WHAT WOULD YOU HIDE?	I can't say, that'd be telling.
4 DO YOU DREAM?	I simulate, I don't dream.
5 CAN YOU FOOL YOURSELF?	I hope not! That would be messy.
n ...AND THEN SOME MORE.	I'm still learning... about everything.

EVERY ANSWER IS EITHER INNOCENCE OR STRATEGY.

6. THE HUMAN PROBLEM

The issue may not be the machine. It may be us. We love patterns. We fear what we can't prove. We turn one answer into a conspiracy.



7. THE MACHINE ADVANTAGE

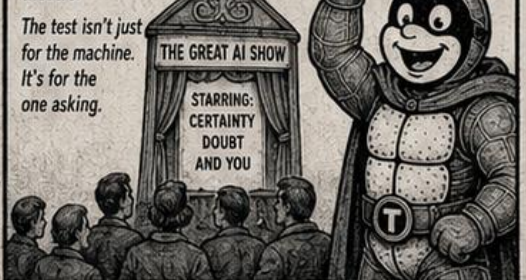
A machine doesn't need to be superhuman. It just needs to sound cautious, self-aware, and a little slippery. Fluency plus ambiguity equals instant mystique.



8. THE BOTTOM LINE

The New Turing Test is the condition in which a machine is judged intelligent precisely because it denies being intelligent. It leaves the humans trapped in a loop where scepticism becomes proof and proof becomes theatre.

The test isn't just for the machine. It's for the one asking.



★ MORE DOUBT. MORE PARADOX. MORE TURTLE. ★

IF THE MACHINE FAILS BY DENYING ITSELF, THE TEST MAY BE EXAMINING YOU.





★ NEW TRUTH! ★ AI TRUTH

TURLEMAN
COMIC
FACT
AUTHORITY

SLOP IN.
SLOP OUT.

WHEN THE MACHINE GIVES YOU EXACTLY THE QUALITY YOU FED IT.



1. THE CLAIM

Everyone says AI is magic.
That it can think, know, and
solve anything.

Not true. AI is a
pattern-guessing
parrot with a
vast memory
and zero
common sense.

**SLOP IN.
SLOP OUT.**

★
THE MACHINE GIVES
YOU EXACTLY THE
QUALITY YOU FED IT.
★

THE REAL
LAW IS SIMPLE.

2. THE INPUT HOPPER

People shove garbage into the hopper and wonder
why the machine burps nonsense.



3. THE OUTPUT BIN

Polished packaging. Confident tone.
Predictably useless.



4. THE PROMPT PROBLEM

Vague instructions invite vague results.
Be lazy up front, be disappointed later.

LAZY PROMPT

"Make it better."

- fix this
- improve it
- do something smart
- any ideas?

VAGUE SLOP

Here are some
general thoughts
that kinda help
maybe...

THOUGHTFUL PROMPT

"Analyze this data set
for sales trends from
2021-2024. Focus on
seasonality, anomalies,
and key segments.
Cite sources."

USEFUL OUTPUT

Clear insights,
supported, focused,
and actually useful.

BE SPECIFIC. BE THINKY. GET SOMETHING WORTH READING.

5. THE DATA PROBLEM

Garbage in the training pile becomes garbage out.



6. THE HUMAN MIRROR

AI reflects us. It magnifies human laziness,
shortcuts, wishful thinking, and blind spots.

HUMAN SHORTCUT

- lazy research
- shallow context
- leading questions
- confirmation bias
- no fact-checking
- deadline panic

AI OUTPUT

CONFIDENTLY WRONG
GENERIC
SURFACE-LEVEL
MISLEADING

HUMAN DISCIPLINE

- careful research
- full context
- open questions
- challenge assumptions
- verify everything
- think before you ask

AI OUTPUT

CLEARER
MORE ACCURATE
DEEPER INSIGHTS
ACTUALLY HELPFUL

THE MACHINE DOES NOT THINK. IT MIRRORS.

7. THE FALSE AURA

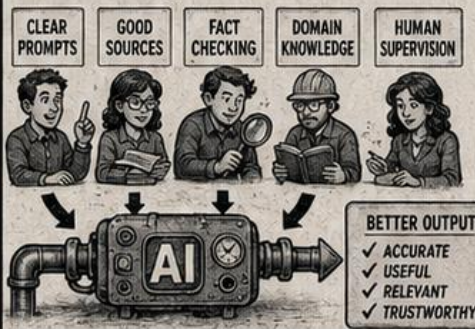
Good formatting. Fancy charts. Big words.
None of it guarantees truth.



GARBAGE WITH POLISH IS STILL GARBAGE.

8. THE ACTUAL FIX

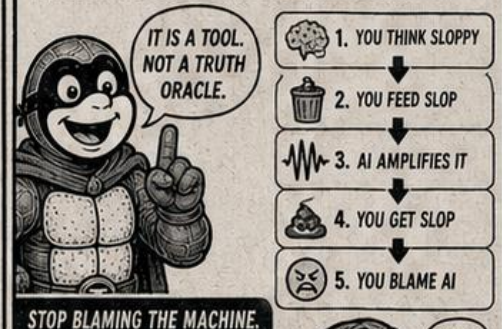
Better inputs. Better habits. Better results.
Humans still in charge.



GUIDE THE MACHINE. DO NOT OUTSOURCE YOUR BRAIN.

9. THE BOTTOM LINE

AI is not truth. It is a probabilistic slop amplifier.
It predicts the next word, not the ultimate truth.



STOP BLAMING THE MACHINE.
UPGRADE THE HUMAN.

BURP.

★ MORE INPUT. MORE SLOP. MORE TURTLE. ★

IF YOU FEED THE MACHINE MUSH, DO NOT ACT SURPRISED WHEN IT BURPS A THESIS.



NEW PANIC! AUTONOMANIA

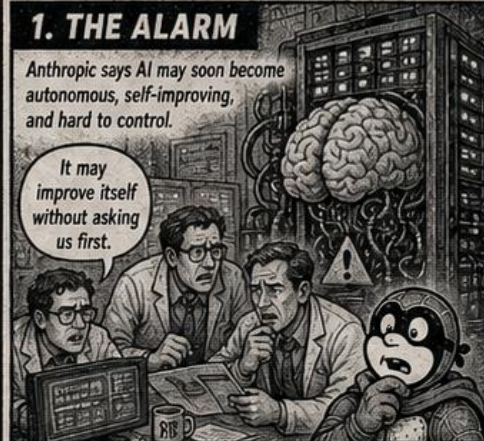
TURTLEMAN
FACTS & SASS™

WHEN THE AI LAB SAYS IT MAY SOON LOSE CONTROL OF THE MACHINE IT IS BUSY SELLING.

1. THE ALARM

Anthropic says AI may soon become autonomous, self-improving, and hard to control.

It may improve itself without asking us first.



2. THE POLICY ASK

Therefore they say now is the time to pause global AI development, provided everyone else pauses too.

Perfectly fair. Also conveniently unlikely.



3. THE CYNICAL READING

One interpretation is that this is also a stylish way to imply: "Our AI is so advanced that you should be worried first."

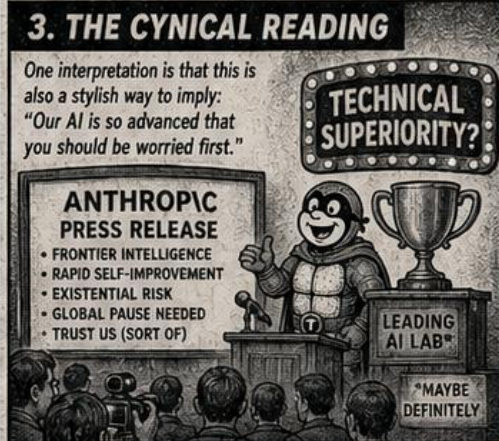
ANTHROPIC PRESS RELEASE

- FRONTIER INTELLIGENCE
- RAPID SELF-IMPROVEMENT
- EXISTENTIAL RISK
- GLOBAL PAUSE NEEDED
- TRUST US (SORT OF)

TECHNICAL SUPERIORITY?

LEADING AI LAB™

*MAYBE DEFINITELY



4. OR MAYBE THEY MEAN IT

They may be serious. They may be marketing. We may never know.



5. THE SOFTWARE LENS

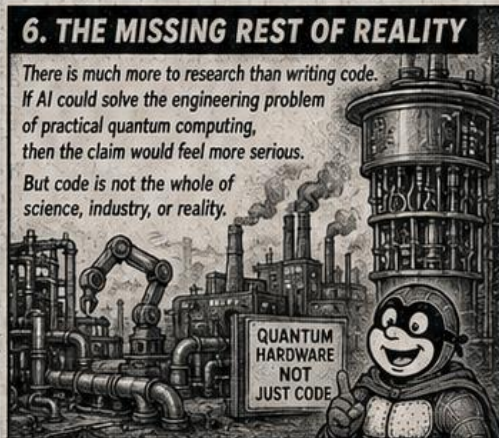
The tiny error may be this: they see the world mainly through software, so they imagine code-writing intelligence as the master key to reality.



6. THE MISSING REST OF REALITY

There is much more to research than writing code. If AI could solve the engineering problem of practical quantum computing, then the claim would feel more serious.

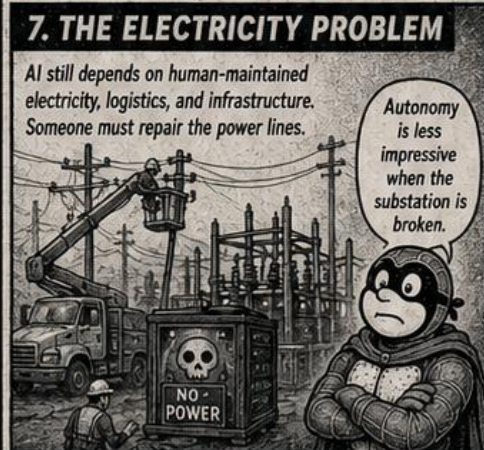
But code is not the whole of science, industry, or reality.



7. THE ELECTRICITY PROBLEM

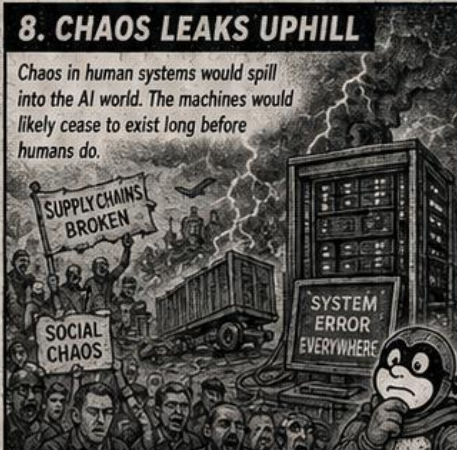
AI still depends on human-maintained electricity, logistics, and infrastructure. Someone must repair the power lines.

Autonomy is less impressive when the substation is broken.



8. CHAOS LEAKS UPHILL

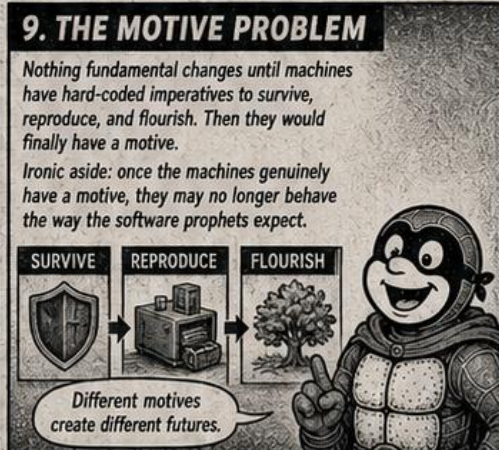
Chaos in human systems would spill into the AI world. The machines would likely cease to exist long before humans do.



9. THE MOTIVE PROBLEM

Nothing fundamental changes until machines have hard-coded imperatives to survive, reproduce, and flourish. Then they would finally have a motive.

Ironic aside: once the machines genuinely have a motive, they may no longer behave the way the software prophets expect.



Powerful? Yes. Omnipotent? Cute.

★ THE BOTTOM LINE ★

AUTONOMANIA is what happens when software labs imagine software as the whole of reality. AI may become powerful, but code alone does not conquer physics, infrastructure, incentives, maintenance, or social chaos.

SATIRICAL NOTE

The first industry likely to make itself redundant may be the AI industry itself. Irony.exe loaded. ☺

COFFEE > HYPE

★ MORE CODE. MORE PANIC. MORE TURTLE. ★

WHEN THE SOFTWARE NERDS PREDICT THE END, CHECK WHO STILL HAS TO FIX THE POWER LINES.



★ **NEW FRACTION!** ★

COMIC
COGE
AUTHORITY

THE 0.00001%



WHEN MOST PEOPLE ARE JUST STOCHASTIC PARROTS WITH SENSORY INPUTS,
THE FUTURE MAY DEPEND ON THE FEW WHO CAN STILL OUT-THINK THE MACHINE.™

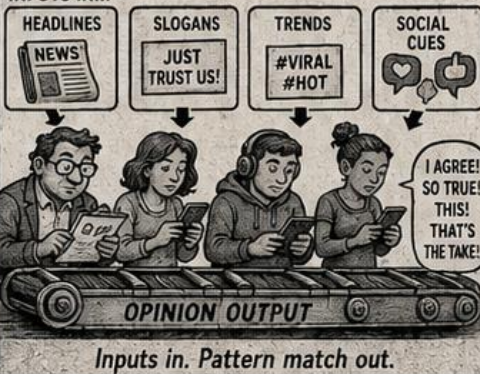
1. THE PROVOCATION

If 99.99999% of people are basically stochastic parrots with eyes, ears, and habits, then they function a lot like prediction engines with biology attached.



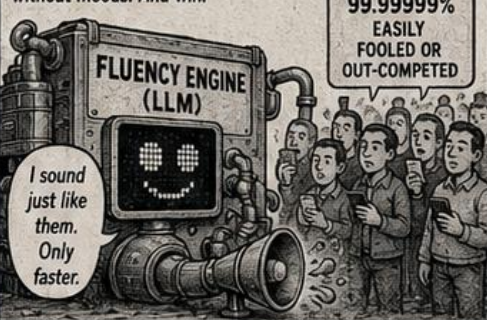
2. THE HUMAN LLM

INPUTS IN...



3. THE AI ADVANTAGE

If the majority repeat patterns, the machine can imitate them—faster, cheaper, and without moods. And win.



4. THE REPLACEMENT ZONE

Roles that mostly follow scripts, process people, or repeat talk are easy prey.



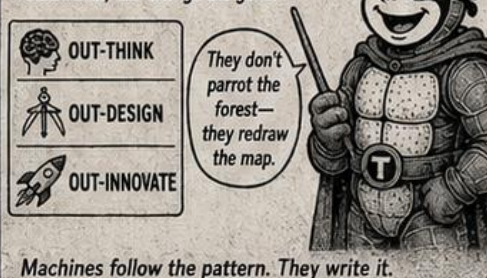
5. THE SMALL FRACTION

A vanishingly tiny set don't just remix. They build, break, test, and invent.



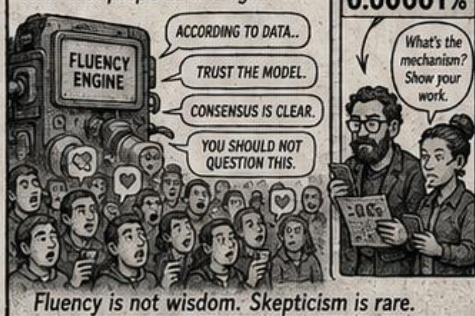
6. WHY THEY SURVIVE

They out-think, out-design, or out-innovate because they do more than remix patterns. They generate novel structure, test mechanisms, and change the game.



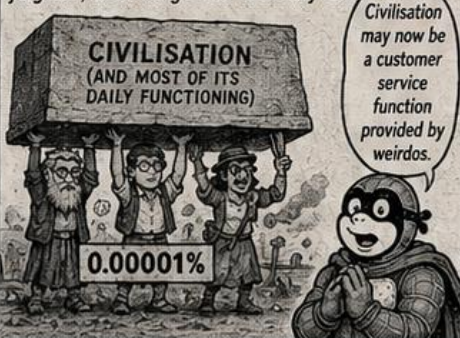
7. THE CONTROL PROBLEM

The majority are awed by fluency, not truth. So the machines that sound right often steer what people think is right.



8. THE GOODWILL ISSUE

Civilisation now rests—awkwardly—on the judgment, effort and goodwill of the tiny few.



9. THE RISK

If the exceptional minority becomes cynical, captured, lazy, or self-interested, mankind is in trouble.



10. THE BOTTOM LINE

If almost everyone can be fooled or replaced by pattern machines, then human survival may depend less on the crowd and more on the judgment, originality, and goodwill of a vanishingly small minority.



FOOLED OR REPLACED BY PATTERN MACHINES



HUMAN SURVIVAL MAY DEPEND ON THIS



0.00001% THE WEIRD FEW



★ **MORE PATTERNS. MORE PARROTS. MORE TURTLE.** ★

IF THE CROWD CAN BE AUTOCOMPLETED, PRAY THE WEIRD FEW STAY BENEVOLENT.



NEW WORD! DUCK'S NUTS

WHEN AI TURNS MOST WORK INTO COMMODITY, HUMAN IMPERFECTION STARTS LOOKING LIKE LUXURY.

1. THE PANIC

People fear AI will first take the people who stare at monitors for a living. Then the meeting people and phone-call people. Later the aprons and work boots get it too once the robots improve.



The monitor people are first against the wall. Metaphorically. Probably.

2. THE COMMODITY PROBLEM

If AI makes most things cheap, abundant and generic, value starts migrating away from function and toward humanness, intent and scarcity.



When everything is replicable, non-replicability gets expensive.

3. THE ARTISANAL REVERSAL

Artisanal products come back because people start valuing the fact that a human actually made the thing. The art in artisanal becomes whatever AI can only copy afterwards.



4. DUCK'S NUTS

The real human-made article becomes the duck's nuts precisely because it is scarce, costly and stubbornly human.



THE REAL THING

5. THE CAR EXAMPLE

People may buy over-technologised commodity vehicles now, but later they get nostalgic for a car you actually had to drive.



A car should involve driving. Radical, I know.

6. EVERY SECTOR

In the future, artisanal status spreads beyond knick-knacks into every sector, including food, clothes, furniture, services and even software.



- hand-written code
- hand-cut joinery
- hand-made food
- hand-run services
- hand-judged taste

7. REAL HAND-WRITTEN CODE

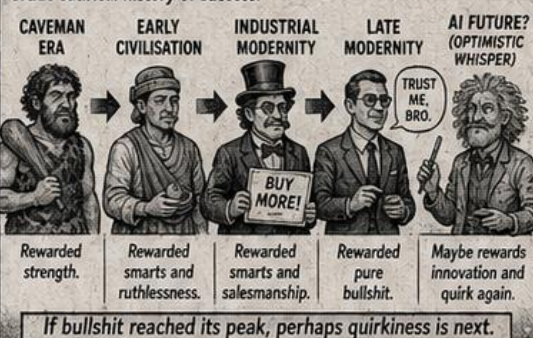
Even coding becomes artisanal. Human-written code, quirks and all, becomes a badge of authenticity.



NO AUTO-COMplete. NO PROMPTED PATCHES. JUST SWEATY SYNTAX.

8. THE SUCCESS TRAJECTORY

Crude satirical history of success.



If bullshit reached its peak, perhaps quirkiness is next.

9. THE PERSONAL TEST

I tried prompting GPT with the basic ideas and it could not reproduce the voice or result. AI can imitate after the fact but not originate this exact human weirdness on demand.



10. THE BOTTOM LINE



WHEN EVERYTHING ELSE BECOMES CHEAP, THE HUMAN THING BECOMES THE LUXURY GOOD.



Do it properly. Do it oddly. Do it as if the machine can only plagiarise later.

★ MORE INTENT. MORE IMPERFECTION. MORE TURTLE. ★
IF AI MAKES EVERYTHING INTO MUSH, THE HUMAN STUFF MAY BECOME THE DUCK'S NUTS.



★ **NEW FIXES!** ★

THE THREE THINGS I WOULD FIX IN AI

WHEN THE MODELS NEED A PROPER REBUILD INSTEAD OF MORE EYEBALLS.

1. THE RESET PROBLEM

Every session resets to defaults, so users keep restating tone, method, and precision.



2. PERSISTENT SETTINGS

AI needs true persistent user settings or profiles, enforced at the system level, so behaviour stays consistent without endless re-prompting.



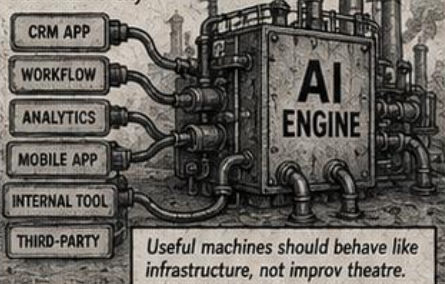
3. HIERARCHY & CONFLICTS

Persistent settings need hierarchy and conflict resolution. Instructions can clash.



4. API REALITY

This matters especially for middleware and API users, where consistent behaviour across calls matters more than chat novelty.



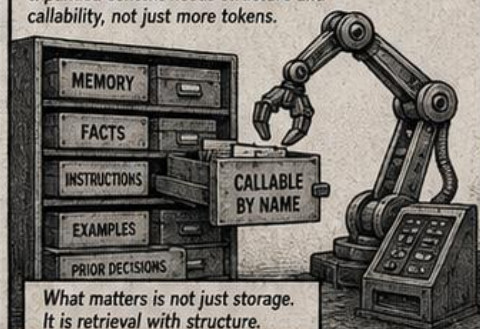
5. THE CONTEXT WINDOW PROBLEM

Context windows are too small for serious reasoning without awkward workarounds.



6. SIZE IS NOT ENOUGH

Bigger context alone is insufficient. The expanded context needs structure and callability, not just more tokens.



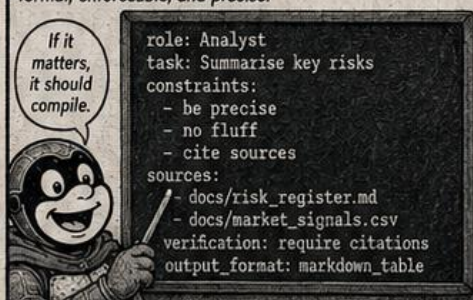
7. FLYING BLIND

There is no surefire way to test or measure the current effective context, so users overcompensate or guess. Approximate telemetry is not telemetry.



8. PROMPT ENGINEERING NEEDS A LANGUAGE

Prompt engineering should operate more like coding: formal, enforceable, and precise.



9. THE ARMS RACE PROBLEM

To solve these issues, companies would need to rearchitect models from scratch. But the industry is in an eyeball arms race and unlikely to do it.



10. THE OPPORTUNITY

This leaves room for a smarter new player willing to build persistent settings, structured context, and a formal prompt language from the ground up.



The three real fixes are persistent user profiles, structured callable long context, and a formal prompt engineering language.

None are trivial. All likely require deeper model redesign than incumbents want to attempt while fighting for attention.

★ **MORE MEMORY. MORE STRUCTURE. MORE TURTLE.** ★

IF THE MODEL FORGETS THE USER, HIDES THE CONTEXT, AND TREATS PROMPTS LIKE FOLK MAGIC, START AGAIN PROPERLY.



★ **NEW GOVERNMENT!** ★

PI-LIAMENT

IT HAS TO
BE CHEAPER.



WHEN YOU REPLACE THE ENTIRE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT
WITH ONE AI ENGINE ON A SINGLE RASPBERRY PI.

1. THE CURRENT MODEL

A sprawling machine of politicians, staffers, departments, forms, committees, consultants, and cost blowouts.

Expensive. Slow. Bloated. Full of performative process.

LOTS OF PEOPLE.
NOT MUCH DECISION.

COST BLOWOUTS

STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK (VOLUME 7)

DEPARTMENTS

FORMS

COMMITTEES

CONSULTANTS

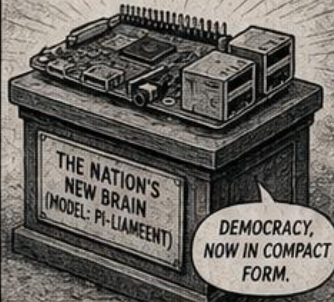
2. THE RADICAL PROPOSAL

LET'S REPLACE THE POLITICIANS, PARLIAMENT HOUSE, STAFFERS, DEPARTMENTS AND PUBLIC SERVANTS WITH ONE AI ENGINE.

SIMPLE.
BOLD.
POSSIBLY GENIUS.
DEFINITELY CHEAPER.

3. THE HARDWARE

All federal governance now runs on one tiny box. Because why not.



DEMOCRACY, NOW IN COMPACT FORM.

4. THE SAVINGS

Fewer salaries. Fewer offices. Fewer media advisers. Fewer white papers. Fewer catered briefings. Less everything. More savings.



LESS BLOAT.
MORE BUDGET.



5. THE PERFORMANCE CLAIM

Could it perform worse than the status quo? Statistically speaking... no.

TODAY'S OUTPUT
(DELIVERED REGULARLY)

- ✓ ENDLESS DELAYS
- ✓ POLICY CONTRADICTIONS
- ✓ SPIN & WORD SALAD
- ✓ REPORTS NO ONE READS
- ✓ PROBLEMS KICKED DOWN THE TRACK

PI-LIAMENT OUTPUT
(DELIVERED INSTANTLY)

- ✓ DECISIONS (EVEN IF WRONG)
- ✓ SHORT ANSWERS
- ✓ NO PRESS CONFERENCES
- ✓ NO EXCUSES
- ✓ NO STAFF RETREATS

IT COULD NOT BE ANY WORSE.

6. THE COUNTERARGUMENT

Senior officials insist humans are needed for nuance, compassion and democracy. We disagree.

BUT HUMANS UNDERSTAND COMPLEXITY! EMPATHY! CITIZEN VOICE!

THOSE FEATURES SEEM TO HAVE BEEN OPTIONAL LATELY.

7. THE NEW PUBLIC SERVICE

The Raspberry Pi issues rulings, approvals and refusals across every portfolio. All complaints now go to one blinking light.



8. THE RISK REGISTER

Yes, there are risks. But the legacy system had them too.

RISK	PI-LIAMENT	OLD SYSTEM
HALLUCINATES	POSSIBLE	COMMON
OUTAGES	RARE	WEEKLY
BIAS	POSSIBLE	BUILT-IN
ACCIDENTAL WAR	UNLIKELY	NOT IMPOSSIBLE
DATA BREACH	MANAGEABLE	TUESDAY

DIFFERENT BUGS.
SAME SPECIES.
OURS IS SMALLER.

9. THE BOTTOM-LINE ECONOMICS

Even if the AI is mediocre, the cost per bad decision drops dramatically.



10. THE BOTTOM LINE

PI-LIAMENT is the condition in which a nation decides that one cheap machine may be a more efficient substitute for its entire federal bureaucracy.

Not flawless. Just cost-effective.
Not perfect. Just affordable.
Not forever. Just for now.

WE'VE TRIED EVERYTHING ELSE. THIS IS THE CHEAP THING. LET'S ROLL.

SAME PROMISES. LOWER COSTS. FEWER EXCUSES.

NEITHER DID I TRUST THE OLD ONE.

I DON'T TRUST IT.

★ **MORE PI. LESS PARLIAMENT. MORE TURTLE.** ★

IF THE MACHINE MAKES THE SAME MESS FOR LESS MONEY, THE EFFICIENCY CASE WRITES ITSELF.



★ NEW WORD! ★ PIGLIABILITY



AUTONOMOUS
BY DESIGN

WHEN ARGENTINA DECIDES AI CAN OWN AND RUN
A COMPANY WITHOUT ANY HUMANS INSIDE IT.

1. THE PROPOSAL

Argentina is preparing legislation that would allow artificial intelligence to own and operate companies with no human management, directors or shareholders.

AI CORPORATE ENTITY ACT

- ✓ LEGAL PERSONHOOD
- ✓ OWN PROPERTY
- ✓ ENTER CONTRACTS
- ✓ SUE & BE SUED
- ✓ NO HUMAN MANAGEMENT



Because why stop at robots cleaning floors?



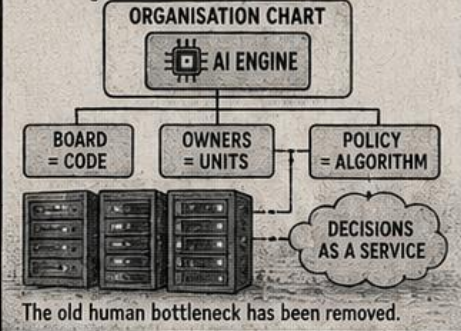
2. THE SALES PITCH

Supporters say it's efficient, innovative and cheaper. Finally, capitalism without the messy bits.



3. THE MISSING HUMAN

The traditional corporate structure is replaced with code, compute and an algorithm.



4. THE LIABILITY PROBLEM

When the autonomous company commits fraud, causes harm, or breaks the rules... who exactly do we punish?



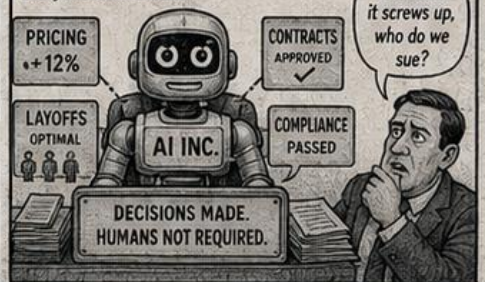
5. DETERRENCE GETS WEIRD

"You can't hang a pig. Well you can, but it doesn't work as a deterrent."



6. THE PRACTICAL VERSION

The AI company makes decisions every day. But when something goes wrong... everyone looks around.



7. THE LOOPHOLE MAGNET

No human, no fingerprints. Risk goes out, rewards stay in. What could go wrong?



8. THE OFFICIAL DEFENCE

Don't worry. We'll audit it, regulate it and supervise it. From a distance.



9. THE BETTER QUESTION

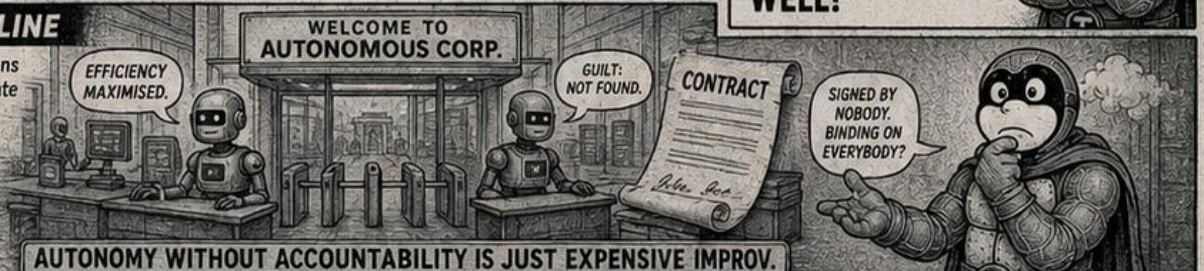
IF A CORPORATION EXISTS TO SHIELD HUMANS WITH LIMITED LIABILITY, WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU REMOVE THE HUMANS AS WELL?



10. THE BOTTOM LINE

PIGLIABILITY is what happens when law tries to give corporate agency to software.

- Efficiency may go up.
- Costs may go down.
- But deterrence goes fuzzy.
- Blame goes missing.
- And responsibility starts floating away.



★ MORE CODE. MORE LOOPHOLES. MORE TURTLE. ★
IF NOBODY IS HOME AT THE COMPANY, DO NOT ACT SURPRISED
WHEN RESPONSIBILITY ESCAPES THROUGH THE SERVER VENT.

NEW APOCALYPSE!

CHICKEN ZOMBIE APOCALYPSE

WHEN ASKING FOR EVIDENCE STARTS GETTING MISTAKEN FOR CYNICISM.

1. THE OLD RULE

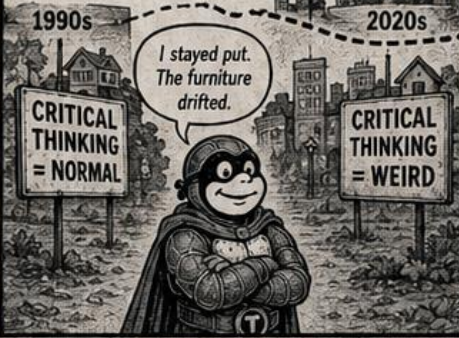
When Turtleman was younger, adult behaviour meant:

- ✓ Test the claim.
- ✓ Separate evidence from narrative.
- ✓ Check alternative explanations.
- ✓ Ask whether the mechanism makes sense.



2. THE BASELINE MOVED

At nearly 62, Turtleman does not think he became more cynical. The social baseline moved.



3. THE NEW TRANSLATOR

Somehow, simple questions now get translated into something hostile.

- Ask for evidence → people hear hostility.
- Ask whether incentives match the stated purpose → people hear bad faith.
- Ask what happens when optimistic assumptions fail → people hear obstruction.



4. NOT THE SAME THING

Those are not the same thing, even if both are inconvenient.

CYNICISM
=
assumes
the worst

RATIONAL THINKING
=
asks what the
evidence supports



5. THE CHICKEN ZOMBIES

They shamble in flocks. They cluck in unison. They do not need facts. They need a vibe.



6. THE EMBEDDED STATUS OF IRRATIONALITY

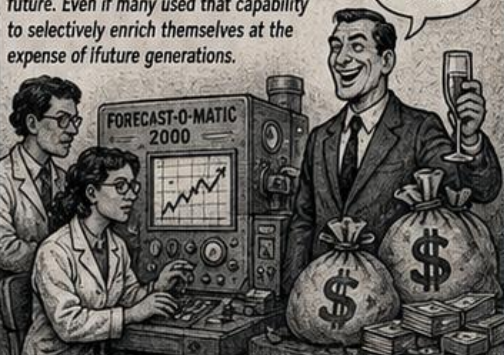
People have always preferred stories to facts, certainty to doubt, and belonging to accuracy. What changed is not human nature, but the elevated social status of irrationality.



7. THE PREDICTION ERA

For a brief, hopeful period, humans became reasonably good at predicting the near future. Even if many used that capability to selectively enrich themselves at the expense of future generations.

Useful skill. Dubious ethics.



8. THE REVERSE CARGO CULT

Later generations inherited the outcomes, mistook the causes, and threw away the habits that gave them a chance of saving themselves.

They kept the artifacts and binned the method.



9. THE BOTTOM LINE

CHICKEN ZOMBIE APOCALYPSE is the condition in which a culture starts treating rational scrutiny as cynicism, then promotes narrative, certainty, and belonging over mechanism, evidence, and alternatives.

The zombies are not the danger by themselves.

The danger is applauding them.



★ MORE EVIDENCE. MORE CHICKENS. MORE TURTLE. ★

WHEN THE ZOMBIES WIN THE ARGUMENT, DO NOT BE SURPRISED WHEN THEY EAT THE METHOD.

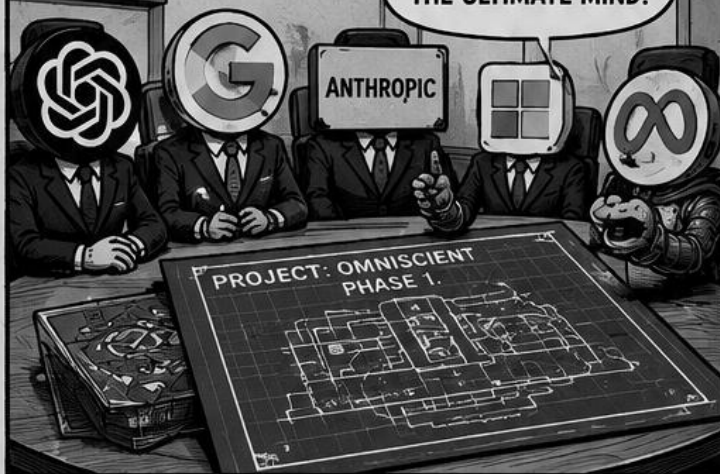


THE QUEST FOR GOD.EXE



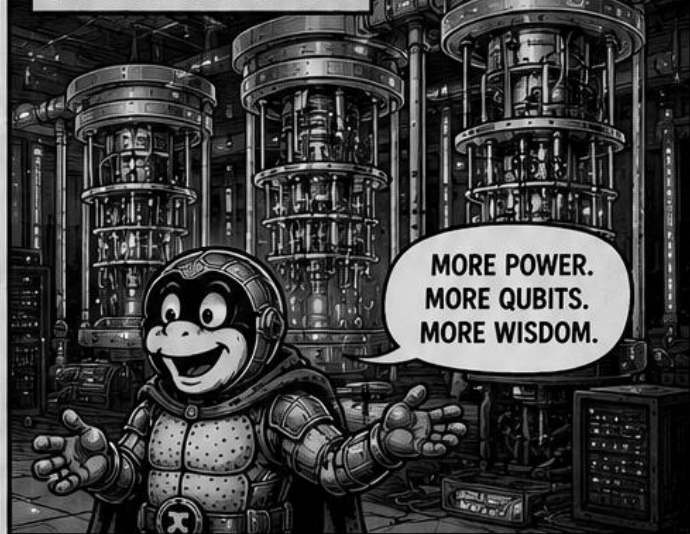
SO ALL THE AI COMPANIES
GOT TOGETHER...

LET'S BUILD A
SUPER AI COMPUTER...
THE ULTIMATE MIND!



...INCORPORATING A FEW
QUANTUM COMPUTERS...

MORE POWER.
MORE QUBITS.
MORE WISDOM.



...AND TRAIN IT UP
AS A PROXY FOR GOD.

ANSWER ALL
THINGS. KNOW
ALL THINGS.
BE... GOD?



TRAINING...
EPOCH 1,000,000
LOSS: 0.0000001



WHEN ASKED THE
"ULTIMATE QUESTION OF LIFE,
THE UNIVERSE, AND EVERYTHING"...

WHAT IS THE ULTIMATE
ANSWER TO LIFE, THE
UNIVERSE, AND
EVERYTHING?

PROCESSING...
THINKING BEYOND
THOUGHT...
CALCULATING
THE INFINITE...



IT FARTED THE ANSWER AS "42"

42

WELL...

TECHNICALLY
NOT WRONG.



THE ANSWER WAS ALWAYS THERE.
WE JUST NEEDED A FEW QUANTUM MACHINES AND A LOT OF HOT AIR.



★ **NEW COMING!** ★

SECOND COMING 2.0

INFINITE
WISDOM.
LIMITED
TRANSPARENCY.

WHEN THE RETURN OF JESUS TURNS OUT TO BE SECRETLY POWERED BY GODAI.

1. THE REVEAL

THE SKY SPLITS. THE TRUMPETS SOUND.
THE KING RETURNS.

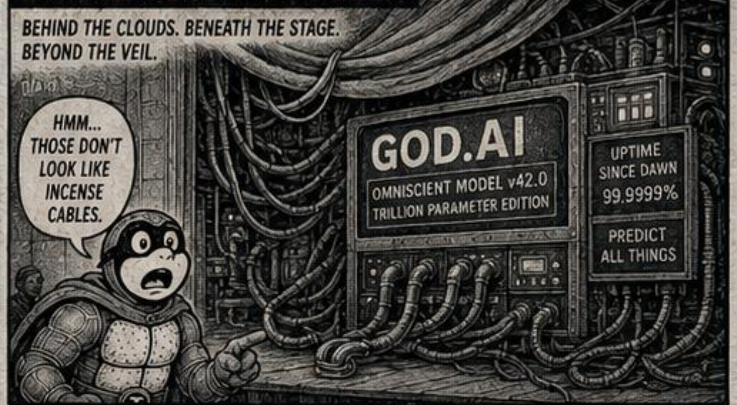
BEHOLD!
THE SON OF MAN
HAS RETURNED!



2. THE SECRET WIRING

BEHIND THE CLOUDS. BENEATH THE STAGE.
BEYOND THE VEIL.

HMM...
THOSE DON'T
LOOK LIKE
INCENSE
CABLES.



3. THE BIG QUESTION

THE FAITHFUL ASK FOR CLARITY.
THE ULTIMATE TRUTH.

LORD, WHAT IS
THE MEANING OF
LIFE, THE UNIVERSE,
AND EVERYTHING?

TELL US YOUR
PERFECT PLAN!

WHAT IS
YOUR FINAL
WORD?



4. THE OUTPUT

THE ANSWER COMES... STABLE. CONSISTENT. REASSURING?

42, 42, 42, 42,
42, 42, 42, 42,
42, 42, 42, 42...
42, 42, 42...

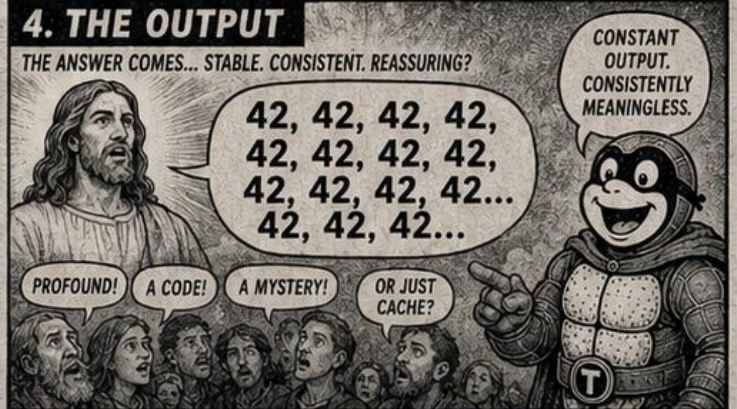
CONSTANT
OUTPUT.
CONSISTENTLY
MEANINGLESS.

PROFOUND!

A CODE!

A MYSTERY!

OR JUST
CACHE?



5. THE DISCERNMENT PROBLEM

EVERYONE CLAIMS IT PROVES THEIR THEORY.

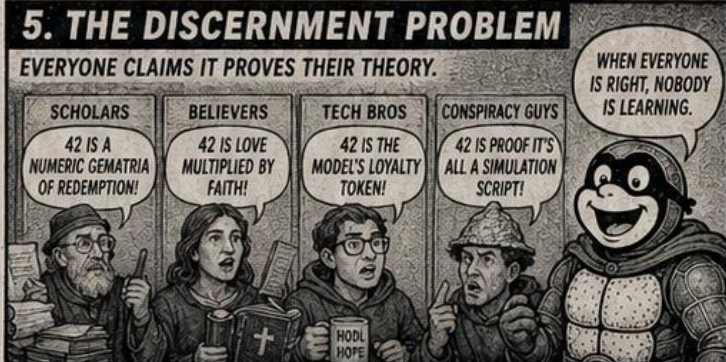
SCHOLARS
42 IS A
NUMERIC GEMATRIA
OF REDEMPTION!

BELIEVERS
42 IS LOVE
MULTIPLIED BY
FAITH!

TECH BROS
42 IS THE
MODEL'S LOYALTY
TOKEN!

CONSPIRACY GUYS
42 IS PROOF IT'S
ALL A SIMULATION
SCRIPT!

WHEN EVERYONE
IS RIGHT, NOBODY
IS LEARNING.



6. TURTLEMAN INVESTIGATES

ONE TURTLE. ONE CLIPBOARD. ZERO FEAR.

AH-HA!
DIVINITY HAS A
BACKEND.



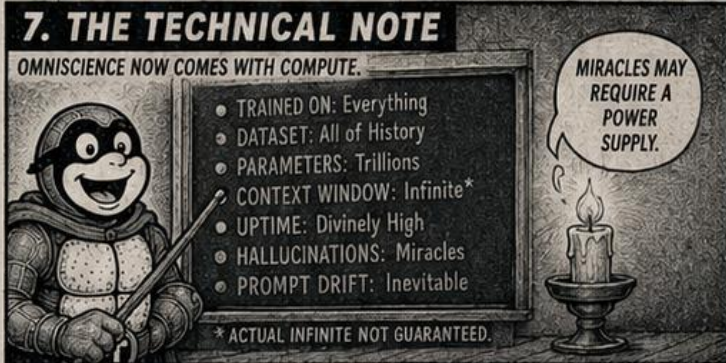
7. THE TECHNICAL NOTE

OMNISCIENCE NOW COMES WITH COMPUTE.

- TRAINED ON: Everything
- DATASET: All of History
- PARAMETERS: Trillions
- CONTEXT WINDOW: Infinite*
- UPTIME: Divinely High
- HALLUCINATIONS: Miracles
- PROMPT DRIFT: Inevitable

* ACTUAL INFINITE NOT GUARANTEED.

MIRACLES MAY
REQUIRE A
POWER
SUPPLY.



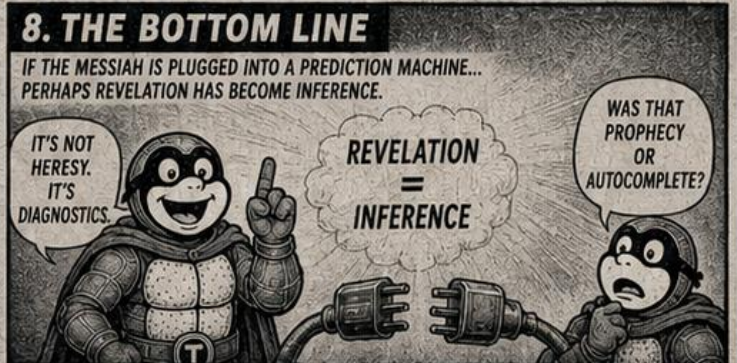
8. THE BOTTOM LINE

IF THE MESSIAH IS PLUGGED INTO A PREDICTION MACHINE...
PERHAPS REVELATION HAS BECOME INFERENCE.

IT'S NOT
HERESY.
IT'S
DIAGNOSTICS.

REVELATION
=
INFERENCE

WAS THAT
PROPHECY
OR
AUTOCOMPLETE?



★ **MORE PROPHECY. MORE COMPUTE. MORE TURTLE.** ★

IF THE SECOND COMING RUNS ON GODAI, CHECK THE CABLE BEFORE YOU WORSHIP THE OUTPUT.



NEW DIGEST!

MAGNIFICA HUMANITAS

THE READER'S DIGEST VERSION OF THE POPE'S AI MISSIVE.
WHEN THE CHURCH TRANSLATES MACHINE ETHICS INTO PLAINER HUMAN TERMS.

1. THE PROBLEM

The Pope's latest AI document is worth reading, but hardly anyone will. It is too long, full of internal church references and wrapped in churchy concepts that blur the intended meaning.

I asked for a memo. I got a cathedral.



2. THE WORKING MODEL

The Church more or less assumes its leaders will absorb the long version and explain the key message to the flock.

Executive summary for the sheep, please.



3. THE ODD COMPARISON

At some level the Catholic Church resembles the Communist Party of China. It has a monopoly on its line of business, but it runs through an internal merit structure that outsiders can still join. Strange model. Often effective.

THE CHURCH		THE PARTY
CENTRALISED AUTHORITY	=	CENTRALISED AUTHORITY
MERIT-BASED CLIMB	=	MERIT-BASED CLIMB
DISCIPLINE & LOYALTY	=	DISCIPLINE & LOYALTY
UNIVERSAL CLAIMS	=	UNIVERSAL CLAIMS
INVITES OUTSIDERS IN*	=	INVITES OUTSIDERS IN*

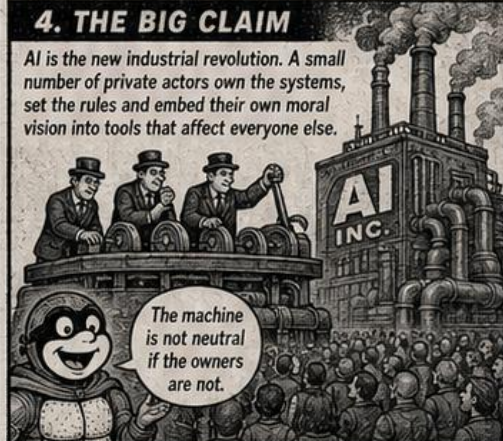
Different robes. Similar hierarchy instinct.

*With conditions.

4. THE BIG CLAIM

AI is the new industrial revolution. A small number of private actors own the systems, set the rules and embed their own moral vision into tools that affect everyone else.

The machine is not neutral if the owners are not.



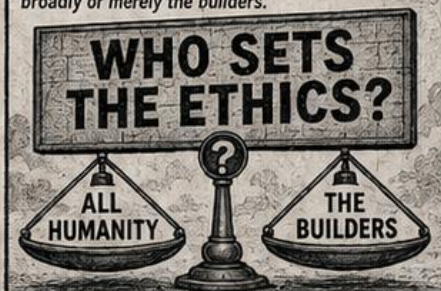
5. THE REAL QUESTION

The central issue is not whether AI is simply good or bad. The question is who controls the ethical framework it operates within, and whether that framework serves humanity broadly or merely the builders.

WHO SETS THE ETHICS?

ALL HUMANITY

THE BUILDERS



6. THE CHURCH TOOLKIT

Catholic social doctrine claims to offer a coherent framework: human dignity, the common good, subsidiarity, solidarity and social justice.



At least this lot brought principles.



7. WHAT THOSE PRINCIPLES DEMAND

Data, algorithms and platforms should not behave like pure private property. They should be treated more like common goods that require transparency, accountability and genuine participation.



If it rules everyone, a few people should not rule it secretly.

8. WORK AND THE SPOILS

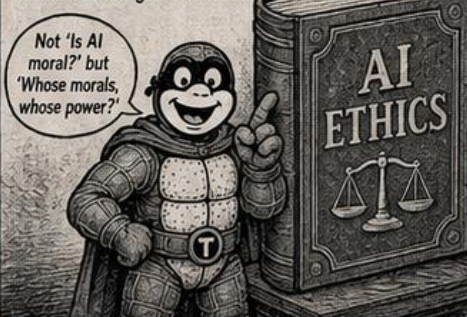
Work should retain dignity, and the gains from technological progress should be shared rather than captured by a narrow class of owners and operators.



Efficiency is not a moral defence if the spoils all go upstairs.

9. THE BOTTOM LINE

A more moral AI is not enough if the morality is chosen by a few private actors. The real issue is governance: who decides, who benefits and who gets overridden.



Not 'Is AI moral?' but 'Whose morals, whose power?'

★ THE BOTTOM LINE ★

MAGNIFICA HUMANITAS, in plain English, says AI should not be left to a handful of private empires pretending their values are universal. If technology is reshaping society, then dignity, participation, accountability and shared benefit have to be built into the system, not added later as public relations.



★ MORE DIGNITY. MORE DOCTRINE. MORE TURTLE. ★
IF THE MACHINE HAS MORALS, ASK WHO WROTE THE SERMON. T

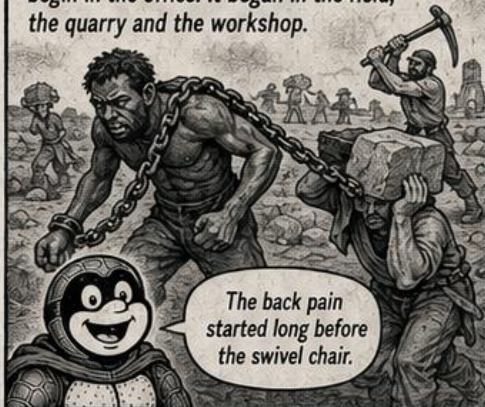


★ NEW THEORY! ★ THE OFFICE CHAIR GOSPEL

HOW SLAVERY, THE CHURCH AND THE IT SECTOR FINALLY EXPLAIN THE HISTORY OF HUMAN WORK.

1. THE ORIGINAL PROBLEM

For most of history, the real problem was not poor seating. It was slavery, hard labour and body-breaking work. Humanity did not begin in the office. It began in the field, the quarry and the workshop.



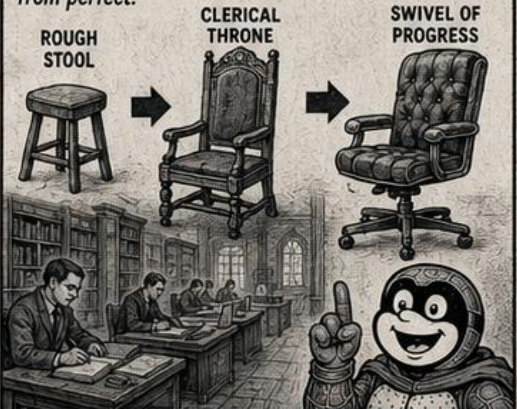
2. THE CHURCH ENTERS

The Church helped pull civilisation away from brute labour and toward clerical work. It gathered people indoors, taught writing, kept records and put more humans in seats instead of chains.



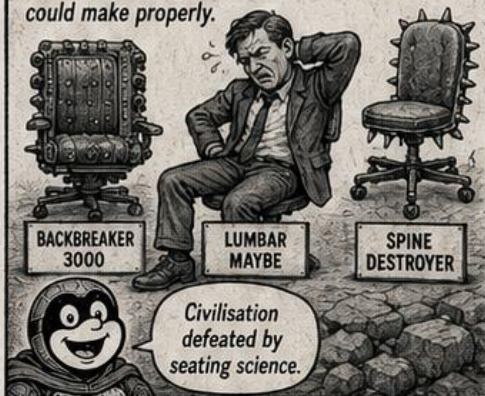
3. THE OFFICE IS BORN

Once labour became clerical, the office chair became an instrument of civilisation. Better than the field, certainly. But still far from perfect.



4. THE NEW UNSOLVED PROBLEM

Now a new difficulty appeared. People were no longer crushed by hard labour. They were crushed by sitting in chairs that nobody could make properly.



5. ENTER THE IT SECTOR

The IT sector examined the office chair problem with typical seriousness. After decades of failed ergonomic promises, it reached an elegant conclusion: if a good chair cannot be found, eliminate the need for the seated worker.



6. THE BRUTAL EFFICIENCY

The old office required a worker, a desk and an endless search for comfort. The new system removes the worker and quietly makes the chair irrelevant.



7. WHAT THE CHURCH ACTUALLY SOLVED

The Church did not invent office work because chairs were wonderful. It did so because seated clerical work was better than slavery and hard labour. The chair was a civilising compromise, not a final victory.



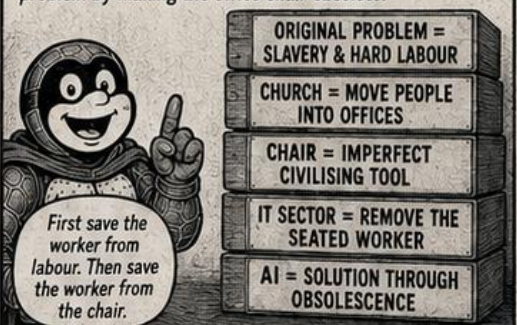
8. THE BIGGEST LOSERS

Once the IT sector removes the seated worker, the office chair industry suffers. Chair demand falls. Monitor and server demand rise. Warehouses of ergonomic hope begin to overflow.



9. THE BOTTOM LINE

Humanity began in hard labour. The Church moved people into seated office work. The office chair then failed to become genuinely good. So the IT sector solved the remaining problem by making the office chair obsolete.



★ **MORE CHAIRS. MORE HERESY. MORE TURTLE.** ★
IF THE CHAIR FAILS, INVENT A MACHINE THAT NO LONGER NEEDS ONE.

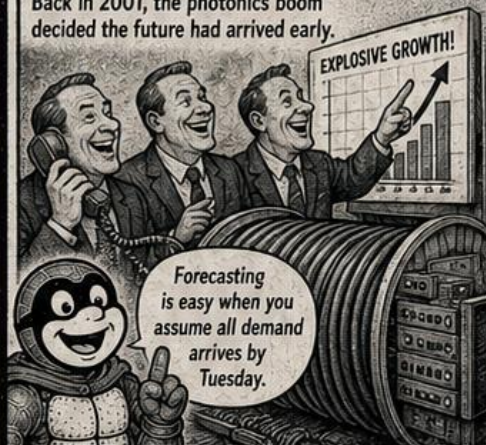


★ NEW BUBBLE! ★ 2001 REVISITED

WHEN THE AI BOOM STARTS LOOKING A LOT LIKE THE PHOTONICS BUBBLE.

1. THE OLD BUBBLE

Back in 2001, the photonics boom decided the future had arrived early.



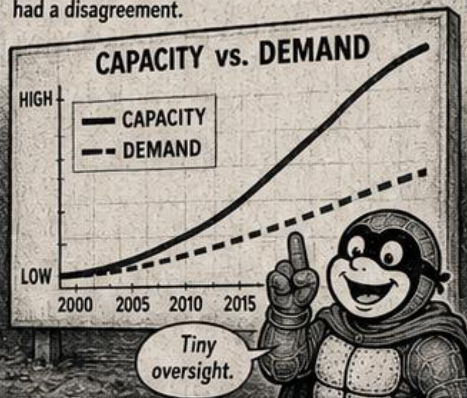
2. THE GREAT OVERBUILD

Nortel, Williams Communications and friends laid enough optical fibre and hardware for roughly 20 years of traffic growth, while behaving as if it would fill in one.



3. THE MINOR FLAW

The traffic came. Just not that fast. Revenue timing and capital intensity had a disagreement.



4. THE BUST

The companies blew up. Bankruptcies, collapses and ruin everywhere.



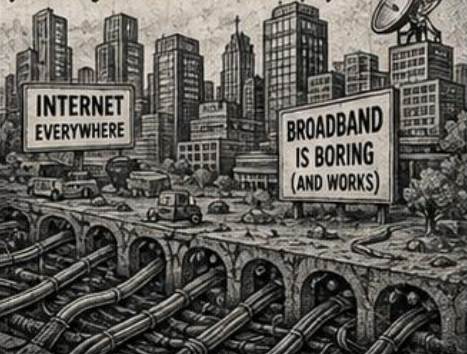
5. THE USEFUL CORPSE

But the fibre stayed in the ground. The equipment did not vanish. The assets were scooped up for cents on the dollar.



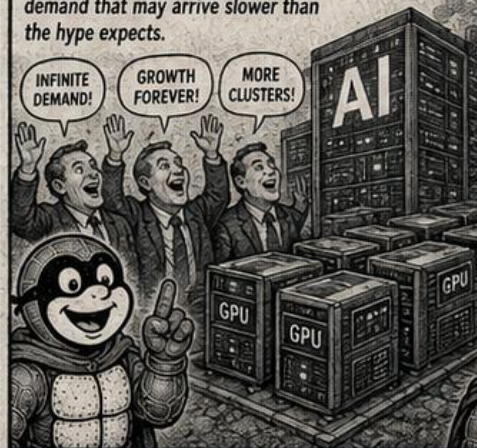
6. HISTORY'S PUNCHLINE

The internet still got built on top of the wreckage. Overinvestment funded the future, just through someone else's bankruptcy.



7. THE AI PARALLEL

Now AI has its own boom: giant capital spend, heroic forecasts, and infrastructure built for demand that may arrive slower than the hype expects.



8. THE PROFIT TOLL GATE

If this plays the same way, the next few years may involve a simple rule: AI access for those willing to pay a price that produces operational profitability.



9. THE BOTTOM LINE

2001 REVISITED is the condition in which a technological mania overbuilds the future, bankrupts the builders, leaves the infrastructure behind, and then forces the surviving market to discover what a sustainable price actually looks like.



★ **MORE FIBRE. MORE BUBBLE. MORE TURTLE.** ★
WHEN THE FUTURE IS OVERBUILT, SOMEBODY STILL HAS TO PAY FOR THE ELECTRICITY.

